WHY AM I UNIQUE?

You are different from everyone else on the planet and anyone who has ever lived. But you're not alone—everybody in the world is biologically unique. Though we all look similar, we're completely different from one another in ways that are impossible to tell at a glance. However, new technology allows these unique characteristics to be scanned and recorded. This information confirms individual identities, which proves useful to police forces and security services.

THE ONE AND ONLY WAY

IMMUNE SYSTEM

Unless you are an identical twin, white blood cells in the body's immune system are unique to you. These cells can tell your cells apart from all of the others. That is why when a foreign cell, such as a germ, enters your body, your white blood cells identify it as an invader and go on the attack, engulfing and digesting it.

IRIS

The colored area of your eye is called the iris. Each iris is a unique blend of stripes and gaps. At the age of ten months, the human iris is fully formed and remains the same. Iris-recognition technology scans the iris to produce a unique pattern similar to a bar code, which can be used for individual identification.

FACIAL STRUCTURE

You're not just a pretty face. The arrangement of your facial features is unique to you. Cameras can capture a face in an image, and then an operator figures out coordinates from the features, such as the distance between the corners of the eyes and the hairline pattern. The list of measurements is used to create a unique facial formula to identify people for security reasons.

FINGERPRINTS

Patterns on your fingerprints are unique. They stay the same throughout your life, and if you injure the skin's surface, the same prints grow back. Fingerprints were first used in 14th-century Persia (modern-day Iran), where it was normal to add a print to official documents. Today, in the U.S. alone, the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) holds a copy of more than 50 million people's prints.